he would usually say nothing," recalled another one of his younger colleagues, Nicholas Gisin. "But if someone would say wrong things, especially on [quantum] interpretations… he was erupting, and then making with his Irish accent very sharp comments and very down to the point and when that started, the speaker could just dissolve and liquify."

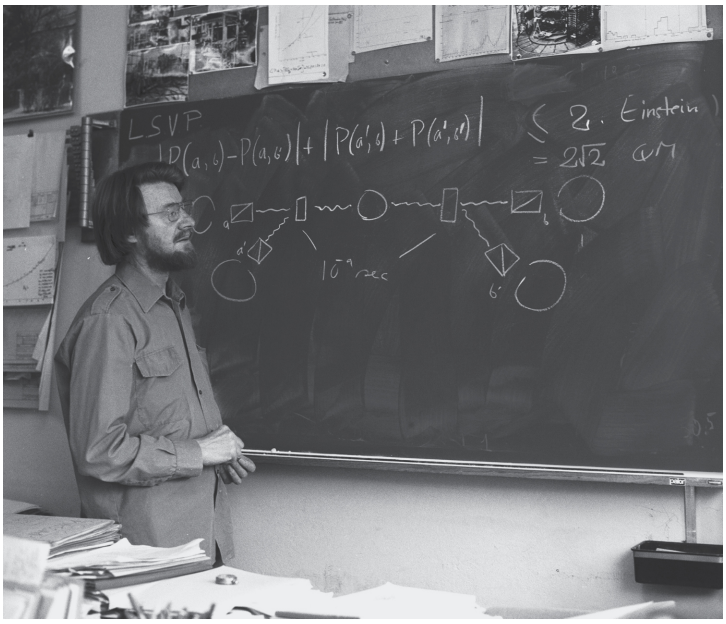


Figure 10.2. John Bell in his office at CERN discussing tests of his theorem, 1982.

But this kind of fire didn't come from anger. It came from Bell's deep moral convictions about the integrity of science, the same kind of moral convictions that had led him to become a vegetarian decades earlier. While the Copenhagen interpretation was unwilling to grapple with the measurement problem, Bell was unwilling *not* to grapple with it. He had no patience for the vagueness of the Copenhagen interpretation and its willingness to kick the can down the road. Though he was wary of encouraging young physicists to devote their careers to foundations, he was patient and kind with anyone who wanted to talk with him on the subject. "When I was asking my questions about foundations, he would be extremely nice and take the time to answer," Gisin recalled. "And when he was coming to my lab to talk… he had this red hair, and this hat, and this little pom pom on top. He was not at all looking like, you know, The Great